

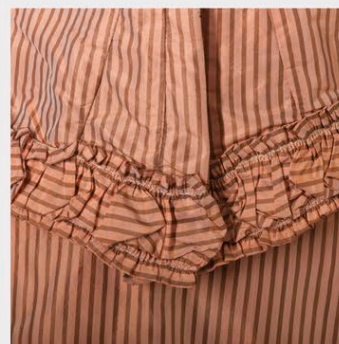


IN DETAIL



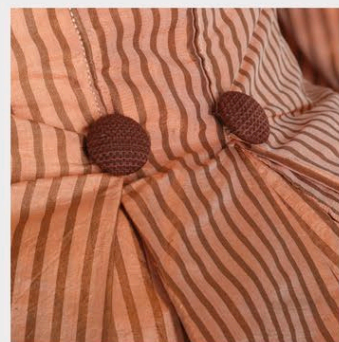
◀ RUCHING TO SLEEVES

Strips of the silk have been ruched and applied as decoration to the sleeves and bodice. The advent of the sewing machine enabled the increasingly complicated decorations and trimmings fashionable at this time. The machine stitching is visible on the sleeves.



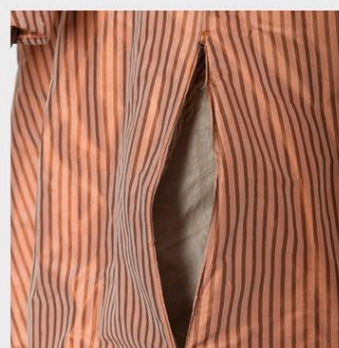
◀ FRONT OF PEPLUM BODICE

The bodice is fastened at the centre front with five metal hooks and eyes for a close fit around the narrow, corseted waist. The bodice extends to a short peplum, which is shaped over the hips into a pointed front and finished with a ruched band of fabric.



◀ BUTTON DETAIL

A pair of brown, fabric-covered buttons trim the centre back waist and mark the top of two deep pleats, which splay over the volume of the bustle. This simple detail draws influence from masculine tailoring and anticipates women's fashions in the following decades.



◀ POCKET

From the 1840s dresses began to have pockets sewn into the skirt. This skirt has an internal pocket lined with glazed cotton, a durable fabric suitable for holding items. The lining discreetly matches the tone of the dress.



◀ HEM

This contrast binding, which was known as brushing braid, was used to finish the hem of the skirt. It would have helped to strengthen and protect the silk as the train trailed on the ground. The brushing braid could be brushed to remove dust and dirt at the end of the day before the outfit was put away.